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SHAKE ON THAT File picture of Adani and PM Modi at a Vibrant Gujarat summit in Gandhinagar

MODI TWEAKED RULES TO AWARD CONTRACTS OF SIX AIRPORTS TO THE ADANI GROUP IN 2018

BJP ministers have demanded evidence, though it's on record that finance ministry and NITI Aayog had objected to allocating more than two airports to one group as building an airport is capital-intensive work

MODI GOVERNMENT AWARDED A DEFENCE MANUFACTURING CONTRACT SIGNED WITH ISRAEL TO THE ADANI GROUP EVEN THOUGH IT HAD NO PRIOR EXPERIENCE

Defence experts say there is no restriction in giving a contract to a company with no prior experience

MODI GOVERNMENT COERCED GVK INDUSTRIES TO SELL MUMBAI AIRPORT TO THE ADANI GROUP

GVK refutes charges; Cong. says selloff result of 2020 EB, CBI raids

THE STATE BANK OF INDIA AND LIFE INSURANCE CORPORATION HAVE EXTENDED MASSIVE LOANS TO THE ADANI GROUP, RISKING THE INVESTMENT OF MILLIONS OF PEOPLE IF THE GROUP GOES BUST

Both SBI and LIC have said their respective exposure to the Adani Group is less than 1 per cent of their total investment

the robustness of its institutional structures." Pointing to the treasury benches, she added, "Don't let him smear your time in government with the stink of crony capitalism. Please immediately order a full, complete and thorough investigation into all matters...our country's reputation is at risk." The Congress and 16 other Opposition parties have demanded a joint parliamentary committee (JPC) or a Supreme Court-monitored probe into the Adani Group. "Only a JPC or an SC-monitored investigation under the CJI can bring out the truth about the 'forced' investments by LIC and PSU banks in companies accused of financial fraud, endangering the hard-earned savings of crores of Indians," stressed Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge.

While leaders in the Rajya Sabha have moved a notice under Rule 267, several Lok Sabha members have moved a similar notice to discuss the issue in the lower house. LS Speaker Birla has denied the requests, asking members "not to make unsubstantiated claims", while Rajya Sabha chairperson and vice-president Jagdeep Dhankhar rejected all motions saying they were "not in order". But the Opposition is adamant.

HUM ADANI KE HAIN KAUN?

The Opposition's attacks continue on different fronts. Playing on a popular romcom title from the 1990s, the Congress has been asking the central government , '*Hum Adani ke hain kaun*? (Who are we to Adani?)', a corollary to which has been three questions posed every day to PM Modi since February 5 on the issue. Congress members have also been protesting in front of the offices and branches of LIC and SBI across India. Via stock investments (LIC) and loans (SBI), both A-list public sector institutions have skin in the Adani game, though both say their exposures are less than 1 per cent of their total investments.

There is a feeling in the Opposition that the Adani controversy could mirror the 2011 moment, when the BJP cornered the Congress-led UPA government over allegations of scams in the allocation of telecom spectrum, coal blocks and infrastructure projects. The last such attempt to target the BJP government was in the run-up to the 2019 general election, when Rahul raised allegations of corruption in the Rafale fighter jets deal. That didn't get much traction then, and it was later even held to be counter-productive to go after Modi directly. The Congress leader will be hoping for an impact more on the lines of his 2015 "*suit boot ki sarkar*" jibe on Modi. That had forced the government to let the controversial land acquisition ordinance—introduced to make amendments to the Right to Fair Compensation and Transparency in Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement (RFCTLARR) Act, 2013—lapse.

Indeed, for Rahul, the charges have come as a vindication of his frequent claim that the Modi government has been unfairly backing two top industrialists. "For a number of years, I have been talking about the government and '*Hum do, hamare do*'. The government does not want...